



Central Banks challenged

This book reviews the threats faced by central banks in the face of climate change. <http://digit.in/mar21-51>



E-Commerce booms

A massive surge in the e-commerce market in India has been studied after the COVID-19 pandemic. <http://digit.in/mar21-52>



Customers in Guangzhou, China "revenge shopping" in a store that had just restarted after lifting of restrictions

Credit: Andrew Joseph Braun / Shutterstock.com

THE BIGGER DISASTER

If eco anxiety is kicking in because of potential green swan events, just wear black eye makeup and go revenge shopping to feel better.

Aditya Madanapalle | aditya@digit.in



RESHAPED RETAIL

To recap, in the early days of the lockdown, all we wanted were some potato chips, but Grofers and Big Basket were crumbling under the load intermittently. Meanwhile in China, the lockdown restrictions were lifting, and something strange began to happen. People started lining up outside luxury outlets as if the act of buying something ridiculous would assuage some of the dismay caused by the restrictions. A Hermes outlet

in Guangzhou broke the record for the largest single day shopping for a luxury store in China, on the day it reopened. The Chinese social media began to call this behavior "baofuxing xiaofei" or "revenge shopping", and pundits expected consumers around the world to participate in such behavior to various degrees, as and when the restrictions were lifted. While some experts predicted that the luxury market was too niche in India to see such a revenge shopping trend, others suggested that there might be a tendency for indulgence shopping. Reports from market trackers show that as the pandemic

progressed, there were some product categories that saw an increase in sales, the top riser being health and wellness products (130 percent over 2019 according to a study linked in the snippets). Now the experts are beginning to understand what really took place, and the situation is far more complicated than anticipated. There have been fundamental shifts in the retail, online shopping and digital payment spaces, with a general increase in digitisation and adoption all around the world. According to research by Shopify, all around the world, consumers prefer greener products, shop on social media, and are going to move more of their purchases online going forward. When it comes to choosing brands, authenticity, transparency, and accountability were major factors, with consumers choosing to support greener brands.



GREEN SWAN

The black swan theory describes a sudden, unpredictable event that seems to disrupt history, science, finance